

LESSON 17

The Who, How, and Why of Baptism

6: Baptism

Executive Summary

Who should be baptized? Those who have consciously placed their faith in Christ — "believer's baptism." How? By immersion, in the name of the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit. Why? Out of obedience to Christ, as a public declaration of faith, and as a testimony of the inward transformation God has already worked in the heart.

Key Terms

Believer's Baptism	Baptism received after personal faith in Christ as a public confession of belonging to Him.
Immersion	Being placed under water in baptism as a picture of burial and raised as a picture of new life in Christ.
Obedience	A willing response to God's authority that puts His commands into practice through faith.
Testimony	A public declaration of what God has done, including baptism's visible confession of faith in Christ.

Key Verses

Matthew 28:19-20 | Acts 2:38,41 | Matthew 3:13-17 | Acts 8:36-38

Application Questions

1. Read Matthew 28:19-20 and Acts 2:38,41. What belief, attitude, or action do these verses call you to embrace?

2. Which key term most clarifies your understanding of believer's baptism, and why?

3. Where does the truth about believer's baptism confront a current assumption, habit, fear, temptation, or responsibility in your life?

4. What specific step of faith or obedience will you take this week, and who can help you follow through?
